

INTERNSHIP PRESENTATION

NEWS-DESK INTERN | ONMANORAMA | MAY-JUN

PRESENTED BY:

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01 I was primarily tasked with finding local stories and news curation, along with features that fit the beat

02 Often news curation involved interviewing people associated with a story, which included professionals, Police officers, and in one case, an IAS official.

03 I was also given a quick intro into mobile journalism. Another key event during the internship was experiencing the newsroom during the 2024 general election.

Overview

OnManorama is an online English portal associated with the Malayalam Daily 'Malayala Manorama'. I was attached to the news-desk at their headquarters in Kottayam, Kerala

Objectives and Goals

Goal # 1

Find news stories, primarily local, that would suit the demographic of OnManorama readers, while adhering to the beats that OnManorama covered.

Goal # 2

Perform telephone interviews to elicit further information. Often professionals and people on site have to be called and their interviews cited for added veracity

Goal # 3

Ensure that all works adhere to the editorial policy. Often political stories have to be neutralised lest the article appear biased

Skills Learnt

Skill # 1 Feature Writing

All the works I had worked on allowed me to hone my skills in writing, especially feature writing

Skill # 2 Interviewing Skills

I learnt how to elicit information and how to use different methods as the position in the chain of command shifted

Skill # 3 SEO

At my time in OnManorama I was made to understand the importance of leveraging trends to bring in more traffic to the website, and as a part of it SEO at its most minimal form was taught

Detours and Impasses

Obstacle # 1 Idea

Often chancing upon an idea for a feature is difficult, especially when local stories are to be covered

Obstacle # 2 Conflicting Stories

Many a times , I was forced to abandon stories owing to how they contradicted with earlier claims. It is generally the rule of thumb to avoid retractions and hence such issues are to be expected

Obstacle # 3 Demography

The reader demography of OnManorama is predominantly older people and laymen and hence niche features- many which I sent- were abandoned

Important Events

Event # 1 Lok Sabha Election

During the elections, us interns were asked to carefully observe how a newsroom operates during an election. The event also allowed me to write a story

Event # 2 Mangaf Fire Incident

The Mangaf fire incident was reported with surgical precision owing to the fact that I, as a former expatriate, had contacts who were there on ground, helping rescue operations

Project - Mobile Journalism

During the internship, me and another intern, Priyamvada, were tasked with going to Kottayam Public Library for a videography assignment with our mobile phones. We together worked on a small script and executed the following :

- Comprehensive coverage of the premises of Kottayam Public Library
- The making and filming of a small storyline of two readers
- Interviews of Kottayam Public Library Staff

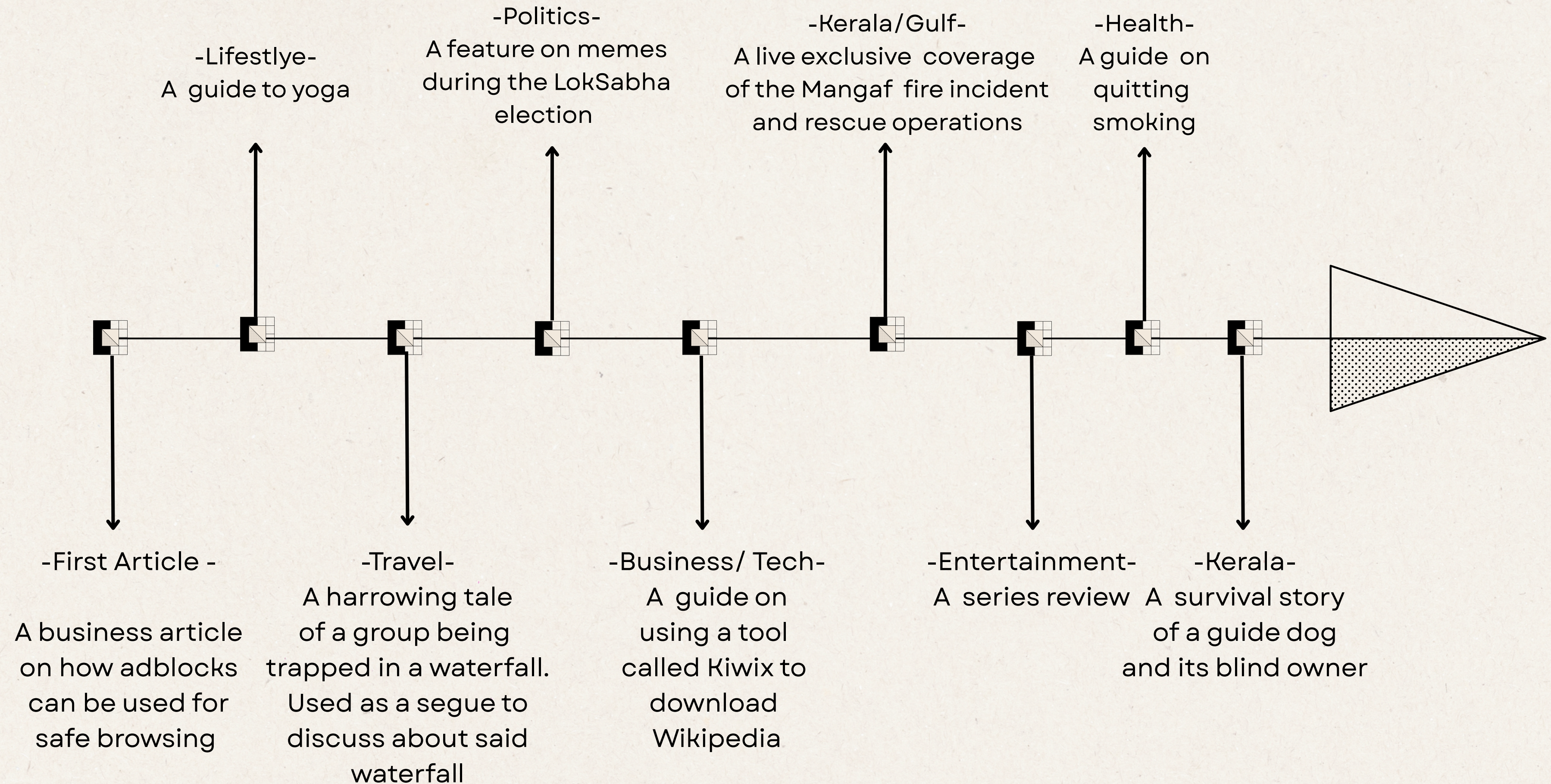


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Curated Collection

<https://thewaywardlaureate.github.io/manoramaworks>





RoadMap

The Road Ahead

Whilst the time at OnManorama was quite didactic, my interests lie in niche circles which include the likes of open source software and privacy, both of which are not recognised beats in Indian Newspapers. However, I learnt to extract information and write them cohesively, a skill which I can incorporate into my interests without any obstacles.

Thank you